

James Inman

LLB (Hons), MSc, MBCS, MRSPH

I am a senior software engineer and technology leader with a strong track record of building and scaling robust, user-focused products – two of which led to successful exits. My core expertise lies in Ruby and Ruby on Rails, but I am technology agnostic, with deep experience architecting, developing, and maintaining modern web applications in high-growth environments. I have led cross-functional engineering teams through the full software development life cycle, combining hands-on coding with strategic technical leadership.

With a background spanning private equity-backed organisations, startups, and SMEs, I bring a blend of commercial awareness and engineering excellence. I work comfortably in fast-paced, agile environments and am confident collaborating with product stakeholders, mentoring engineers, and contributing to long-term architectural decisions, with a product-first/database-design mindset throughout my work.

Desired Role: After experience in purely hands-on and management roles, I remain passionate about working closely with technology, especially with the advent of AI. I am now looking for either a hands-on role as an individual contributor (Staff-level Engineer), or leading a small delivery team.

Technologies

I have had exposure to a wide range of technologies over my career and am adept at picking up new technologies, as well as leading teams in technologies where I do not have direct hands-on experience. These are the technologies I'm currently working with, or have in the last 12 months, from "Foundational" (I've had exposure) through "Working Knowledge" (I can make most things happen and am comfortable diving in) to "Advanced":

I also have extensive knowledge of data regulation including GDPR and HIPAA, information security standards including ISO27001 and Cyber Essentials, and applying these to system design and analysis.

Backend

Ruby / Ruby on Rails / RSpec ADVANCED
Python WORKING KNOWLEDGE
node.js WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Git ADVANCED
GitHub Actions / CI & CD Pipelines ADVANCED
API Design ADVANCED
DataDog / AppSignal / Sentry ADVANCED
Web Penetration Testing WORKING KNOWLEDGE
WebRTC / NAT Traversal ADVANCED

Frontend

HTML / CSS ADVANCED
JavaScript ADVANCED
TypeScript WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Hotwire / Stimulus ADVANCED
React WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Next.JS WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Tailwind CSS ADVANCED
Bootstrap ADVANCED

Scripting, Automation & OSs

Terraform ADVANCED
Ansible ADVANCED
zsh/Bash WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Docker ADVANCED
Kubernetes WORKING KNOWLEDGE
macOS ADVANCED
Debian / Ubuntu / CentOS ADVANCED
AWS WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Microsoft Azure ADVANCED
Google Cloud Platform FOUNDATIONAL

Data & Generative AI

Database Modelling ADVANCED
PostgreSQL / MySQL / MariaDB ADVANCED
MongoDB WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Redis WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Jupyter WORKING KNOWLEDGE
dbt WORKING KNOWLEDGE
Snowflake ADVANCED
ChatGPT / Codex / Claude Code ADVANCED
Prompt Engineering ADVANCED
Local LLMs / Fine-Tuning WORKING KNOWLEDGE

Employment History

Principal Ruby Engineer / Digital & Information Security Consultant (Otaina)

August 2023 – Current: Providing digital consultancy and web development services to a range of organisations. Contracted full-time at Indeed Flex (April 2024–July 2025) as a Staff-level Software Engineer at Indeed Flex, a subsidiary of Indeed, working across the data stacks (PostgreSQL/Snowflake) on data investigations, and web application (Ruby on Rails).

Alongside and since working at Indeed, I have been building a Rails engine to act as a (WYSIWYG) “what you see is what you get” CMS, using Rails 7 (then 8), Hotwire (Stimulus) and Postgres/SQLite.

Since August 2024, I have been providing some technology due diligence services to PE companies, but primarily working with a number of non-profit organisations on internal applications. I am working on projects to train local LLMs (through both prompt engineering and fine-tuning) to handle secure data, and have worked extensively with AI tools (my current preference being Claude Code) for development.

Key Achievements: Whilst contracting at Indeed Flex, launched a new “backend for frontend” mobile application for Indeed Flex workers; planned project and delivered to schedule; contributed substantial Ruby/Rails code to the project and led team of 6 Ruby/mobile engineers. Investigated and root caused an issue showing incorrect pay values to workers which had been subject to 18 months of hotfixes.

Founder (Inclusive Jobs)

August 2023 – April 2024: Inclusive Jobs was a startup providing training, consultancy and a software platform for employers to help them support and recruit neurodivergent employees. I was responsible for ideation, overall strategy, and technology, and personally trained a number of organisations including Aer Lingus and BBC to improve their neuroinclusion. I built a Ruby on Rails platform (with support from a team of three volunteers) to connect employees with jobs matching their preferences. The platform concluded in April 2024 following changing market conditions.

Chief Product & Technology Officer, latterly Chief Technology Officer (Juniper Education)

September 2021 – July 2023: I held a Board position at Juniper Education, a PE-backed education technology organisation. As Chief Product and Technology Officer from January 2021, I had responsibility for the product strategy and product management team working across 12 acquired products, plus managing the consolidation of these into a single proposition and build of new cloud-based applications to support over 12,000 schools. I was responsible for technical and product due diligence on acquisitions and partnerships. I divested day-to-day responsibility of the Product function in November 2021, and took on an expanded technical role including Group information security and IT systems.

Key Achievements: Strategy creation for a single Juniper platform and interface to deliver all products as one, leading on market research and analysis. Restructure of and responsibility for the product, design and engineering teams, with budget management of £4.1m annual spend and ~95 staff members. Led product and technical diligence on multiple potential and realised acquisitions.

Director of Product Strategy (Impero, now Ativion)

September 2019 – September 2021: Following a change in company leadership, I took on an expanded role at Impero, with a goal to transform the company’s technical team and product strategy. Reporting into the CEO and working closely with our private equity investors, I rebuilt the engineering and product teams and created the company’s long-term product strategy and platform, with a successful and loyal team. I held responsibility for both the engineering and product team of 65 people across 4 countries, and managed a

headcount budget of £3.1m.

Key Achievements: Rebuilding the engineering team and product family within budget and ahead of schedule, bringing a range of successful products to market. Acting as a core part of the company's M&A team, with responsibility for all technical and product due diligence on acquisition targets, as well as assisting with investor projects. I also acted as the group's Data Protection Officer.

Managing Director (Safeguarding Monitor), Product Director (Impero, following acquisition)

July 2017 - September 2019: I began work on a next-generation digital safeguarding system for schools, Safeguarding Monitor, and built the team to 14 people, closing the sale of the company to Impero in September 2019. At Impero, I acted as a Product Director, reporting to the CEO and Board for the suite of safeguarding products, where my focus was the expansion into the US educational market and global non-education organisations. I also provided technical consultancy for the wider organization, including Agile and delivery management.

Key Achievements: Negotiating and closing the acquisition of Safeguarding Monitor by Impero, leading the sales process and on-boarding one of the UK's largest multi-academy trusts and multiple Premier League football clubs, undertaking requirements gathering in the US to develop the product for the needs of that market.

Co-Founder and Managing Director (Centu Consultancy)

January 2014 - June 2017: Centu began as a vehicle for my part-time role with a national charity, IPSEA. I worked closely with the CEO and Trustees and gained strategic responsibility for IT systems and system development throughout the organisation. I then took Centu full-time, and grew the company to a staff of 12, working with a number of national clients to produce bespoke business systems, mobile applications and education SaaS products.

Key Achievements: Winning a 'Made In Bury' Business Award, personally being shortlisted for the E3 Awards' Young Entrepreneur Of The Year award, achieving ISO27001, ISO9001 and Cyber Essentials certification.

Lead Web Developer (Ticketline)

June 2014 - September 2015: At Ticketline I led development on a self-service ticketing system, Ticketlight, from specification through to delivery, including feature development, regular code reviews and project management. I was also responsible for managing developments on the company's main e-commerce website (£12m+ revenue/annum), including adding basket and "up selling" functionality, and all recruitment and HR (including performance reviews) for the web team.

Key Achievements: I successfully managed the development and launch of Ticketlight, which prior to joining the company was subject to two years of unsuccessful development, meeting all budgetary and time estimates set.

Interim Senior Developer (RE:Systems)

January 2014 - June 2014: My role was managing the web development team through a transition to a new office and structure (both employees and contractors) on a day-to-day basis in an Agile environment, and putting in place processes to ensure efficiency and quality of output.

Key Achievements: Delivering a ground-up redevelopment of the company's custom content management

system; proposal writing resulting in the company securing £250,000+ of web development work in six months, recruiting and successfully managing the web development team.

Project Lead, Timetastic (Mediaburst)

March 2012 – January 2014: I was the lead developer of Timetastic, a freemium SaaS platform for staff leave management. I planned and implemented a prototype of the product in Ruby on Rails, before leading on the rewrite of the system in PHP, and recruiting the development team. I also re-developed the company's 12 WordPress plugins for sending SMS messages, was the main developer evangelist, and had responsibility for internal contracts and information security standards.

Key Achievements: Taking Timetastic from concept to 8000+ users and successfully billing over 2000 customers; playing a key role in the introduction of Agile development to the company; introducing PHP standards; internal lead on contracts and data protection agreements for the company's e-healthcare product, Florence.

Founder (Montrose River) / Lead Consultant for CPOMS (Meritec)

February 2010 – March 2012: I dropped out of university to found Montrose River with a vision to transform child protection reporting for schools, social services, and healthcare departments by moving paper-based systems to the cloud; this became a product known as CPOMS. I was responsible for the day-to-day operations of the company (including recruitment), full architecture and development of CPOMS, and field sales to school groups. After the acquisition of CPOMS by Meritec, I continued in the same role until March 2012. Whilst at Meritec, I also led the development of a next-generation e-learning system for local authorities, 'Focus On...'

Key Achievements: Successfully implementing CPOMS from concept to use in 35+ schools; conducting three audiences for MPs and Ministers at the House of Commons; leading on legal and policy, including contracts, data protection, and security; wrote custom security firmware for the Yubikey.

Freelance Web Developer (whilst studying)

May 2009 – February 2010

Qualifications

MSc in Psychology

BPP University, 2020-2025

MSc Dissertation: Interpretative Phenomenological Analysis of sensory processing and interpersonal touch in adults with Developmental Coordination Disorder/Dyspraxia.

Bachelor of Laws, 2:1 (Honours)

The Open University, 2015

Certificate in Software Engineering

Durham University, 2010

Certificate in Web Applications Development

The Open University, 2009

Memberships, Training & Volunteering

Member of the British Computing Society

Member of the Royal Society for Public Health

Student Member, British Psychological Society

Student Member, British Association for Counselling and Psychotherapy

Do-IT Neurodiversity Champion (2023)

Mental Health First Aider (2021)

Volunteer, IPSEA (2013-2016)

I volunteer for RENEW Counselling, a charity providing counselling services in Essex. I am a founding Trustee of neurobetter, a charity providing mental health services to support neurodivergent individuals.